SALESFORCE ADMIN COURSE

EPISODE 17 • STUDY NOTES

Validation Rules in Salesforce Prevent Invalid Data Entry

A complete, easy-to-revise breakdown of the video — with tables, diagrams, formula examples, and a step-by-step guide.

WHAT'S INSIDE

- What are Validation Rules
- Why we need them
- Rule components
- Formula & Error Messages
- Real-life examples
- Best practices

1 Introduction 0:00 – 0:40

After Schema Builder, here's a critical question: what if users enter **incorrect or incomplete data** — a 5-digit phone number, a badly formatted email, a negative salary, a student record with no roll number? That's exactly what **Validation Rules** prevent.

> **Covered today:** What Validation Rules are • Why we need them • Rule components • Formula & Error Messages • Real-life examples • A full practical demo

2 What are Validation Rules? 0:40 – 2:20

Think of an online registration form — leave the Email field blank or type an invalid phone number, and the site immediately shows an error and blocks you from continuing. Salesforce works the same way.

IN SIMPLE WORDS

A Validation Rule prevents users from saving incorrect or incomplete data in Salesforce

> **How it works:** Salesforce checks a condition. If it's **TRUE**, the record is blocked and an error message is shown. If **FALSE**, the record saves normally.

3 Why Do We Need Validation Rules? 2:20 – 4:00

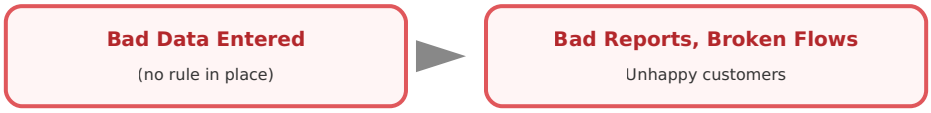
Businesses rely on accurate data. Bad data entered once can ripple through the whole system.

Consequences of Bad Data

- Wrong reports
- Failed automations
- Incorrect emails
- Poor customer experience

How Validation Rules Help

- Ensure data accuracy
- Maintain consistency
- Prevent incomplete records
- Enforce business rules
- Improve data quality



4 Components of a Validation Rule 4:00 – 6:00

Every Validation Rule has **three** main parts:

1. Rule Name

A unique name used to identify the Validation Rule — e.g. *Age_Validation*.

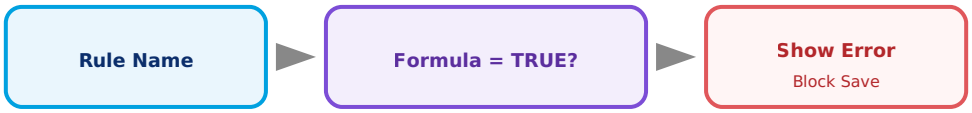
2. Formula

The logic Salesforce evaluates. If it returns **TRUE**, Salesforce throws an error. If **FALSE**, the record saves successfully.

3. Error Message

The message shown to the user when validation fails — e.g. *"Email Address is mandatory."* A good message clearly tells the user what to fix.

How the Three Parts Work Together



5 Real-Life Examples

6:00 – 8:00

Example 1 — Salary

Don't allow Salary to be negative.

Example 2 — Student Age

Student Age must be greater than 5 years.

Example 3 — Email

Email field cannot be blank.

Example 4 — Opportunity Close Date

Close Date cannot be in the past.

These are common business rules enforced using Validation Rules.

6 Practical Demo 8:00 – 13:00

Let's build three Validation Rules on the **Student** object. In each case: go to **Object Manager → Student → Validation Rules → New**.

Example 1 — Age Validation

Rule Name: Age_Validation

```
Age__c < 5
```

Error Message:

Student age must be at least 5 years.

Test: create a record with Age = 3 → Salesforce blocks the save and shows the error.

Example 2 — Percentage Validation

```
OR(
  Percentage__c < 0,
  Percentage__c > 100
)
```

Error Message:

Percentage must be between 0 and 100.

Test: try entering 120% → Salesforce blocks the record.

Example 3 — Mandatory Phone Number

```
ISBLANK(Phone__c)
```

Error Message:

Phone Number is required.

Test: try saving without a phone number → Salesforce immediately displays the error.

All 3 Demo Rules at a Glance

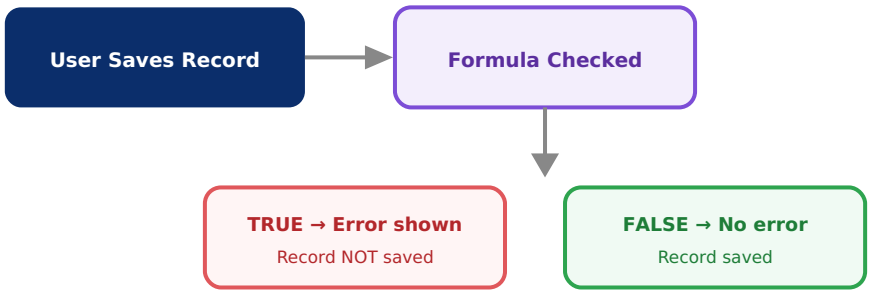
Rule	Formula	Error Message
Age Validation	Age__c < 5	Student age must be at least 5 years.
Percentage Validation	OR(Percentage__c < 0, Percentage__c > 100)	Percentage must be between 0 and 100.

Mandatory Phone	ISBLANK(Phone__c)	Phone Number is required.

7 Best Practices 13:00 – 14:00

- ✔ Write clear and meaningful Rule Names
- ✔ Keep formulas simple whenever possible
- ✔ Show user-friendly, specific error messages
- ✔ Test the rule thoroughly before deploying it
- ✔ Avoid unnecessary Validation Rules that make data entry difficult

8 Validation Rule Flow — Recap Diagram



9 Episode Summary 14:00 – 15:00

- ✔ Validation Rules prevent incorrect or incomplete data from being saved
- ✔ They protect report accuracy, automation, and overall data quality
- ✔ Every rule has 3 parts: **Rule Name**, **Formula**, and **Error Message**
- ✔ If the formula returns TRUE, the record is blocked; if FALSE, it saves
- ✔ Common examples: no negative salary, minimum age, mandatory fields, valid date ranges
- ✔ Best practice: keep formulas simple, error messages clear, and test before deploying

That wraps up Validation Rules — one of the most practical tools for keeping Salesforce data clean and trustworthy.